



CAP Premier League 2026

Tournament Rules & Regulations

Cricket Association of Peoria

SEASON 2026

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1. Tournament Format & Structure

League Stage

- **18 teams** divided into **2 groups of 9** (Group A & Group B).
- Each team plays **8 league matches**.
- All league-stage games are **15 overs** per side.
- Points: **Win = 2 pts**, Loss = 0 pts, Washout = 1 pt each, Tie = 1 pt each.

Division Split

Division	Qualification	Teams	Overs
Division 1	Top 4 from each group	8 teams	20 overs
Division 2	Bottom 5 from each group	10 teams	15 overs

Division 1 — Cross-Group Format

- Teams play **3 cross-group matches**.
- A1 plays B2, B3, B4 | A2 plays B1, B3, B4 | A3 plays B1, B2, B4 | A4 plays B1, B2, B3
- Division 1 standings are **independent** — based on Division 1 games only.

Division 2 — Cross-Group Format

- Teams play **3 opponents from the opposite group** (randomly drawn from the 5 teams in the other group).
- Division 2 standings are **independent** — based on Division 2 games only.

Knockout Stage — Super Groups

- **Super Group 1 (Division 1):** Combined points table across both groups for Division 1 games only. Top 4 qualify.
- **Super Group 2 (Division 2):** Combined points table across both groups for Division 2 games only. Top 4 qualify.
- Teams ranked by points, then NRR (independent of league stage results).
- Semi-Final 1: 1st vs 4th
- Semi-Final 2: 2nd vs 3rd
- Final: Winners of Semi-Finals

2. Game Schedule & Timings

Venue Allocation

Stage	Venue
League Stage	CAP Ground / Mossville
Division 1	CAP Ground / Mossville
Division 2	CAP Ground / Mossville
Semi-Finals & Finals	CAP Ground

Game Time Slots

Slot	Time	Duration
Morning	9:30 AM – 12:30 PM	3 hours
Afternoon	12:45 PM – 3:45 PM	3 hours
Evening	4:00 PM – 7:00 PM	3 hours

 **Innings Time Limit:** Each innings must be completed within **75 minutes**. Umpires and captains are responsible for maintaining the over rate and ensuring the innings finishes on time.

Minimum Players & Toss

- A team must have a minimum of **7 players** on the ground to start the game.
- Toss time is **10 minutes before** the scheduled start. Playing XI must be updated in CricClubs before the toss.
- If a team does not have 7 players for the toss, they forfeit the toss. If both teams don't have enough, the first team to reach 7 wins the toss.
- No additional players allowed after **30 minutes** from game start. No excuses.

Late Arrival Penalties

Example: If the game is scheduled at **10:00 AM**, the team must have 7 players on the ground and be ready to start.

10:10 AM (10 min late): Team loses **1 over**.

Every 5 minutes after that: 1 additional over deducted (10:15 = 2 overs, 10:20 = 3 overs, etc.).

30 minutes late: If team still does not have minimum players, game is **forfeited**.

 Umpires **MUST** enforce this rule strictly. One delayed game must NOT affect the next scheduled game.

3. Player Eligibility & Registration

Minimum Games for Playoffs

A player must have played a **minimum of 5 games** during the league and division stages to be eligible for knockout matches (semi-finals and finals).

Player Identity & Photos

- Every player **must** have a clear profile picture uploaded in the CricClubs app. The face must be clearly recognizable.
- If a player not on the roster plays under a different player's name, the team has **1 week** to update the roster and correct the scorecard in CricClubs.
- This is **only allowed once per team** for the entire tournament.
- If it happens a second time, the unregistered player is **not allowed to play** and the team must play with **10 players** (or fewer if more unregistered players are involved).
- Umpires are authorized to check player identity using a photo ID during any game, especially during playoffs.

 **One chance only.** First time — update the roster within a week. Second time — the player is out and the team plays short.

Waiver Form

- A waiver form is required for all **under-18 players**. The waiver must be signed by a parent or guardian **before the start of the game**.
- Under-18 players without a signed waiver are not eligible to play.

Player Transfers

No player transfers are allowed. A player must not have played even a single game for another team.

If a player wishes to switch teams, they must email CAP at **cappeoria1@gmail.com** **before** playing any game. Once a player has appeared in any match for a team, they cannot transfer.

Roster Changes

A player who has **already played a game** cannot be removed from the roster to make room for a new player. If the roster is full and the team wants to add someone, they must free a spot by removing a player who has **not yet played**.

Registration Fees

- Tournament registration fee: **\$500 per team**.
- Payment method: **Chase QuickPay / Zelle** (preferred) to **cappeoria1@gmail.com**.
- Checks should be made payable to **Cricket Association of Peoria**.

Late Payment Penalties:

Paid after Week 1 of games starting: additional **\$50 fine**.

Paid after Week 2 of games starting: additional **\$100 fine**.

Not paid by Week 2: Team is **excluded from the tournament**. No exceptions.

4. Game Rules

Match Format

Stage	Overs	Max Overs per Bowler	Players
League Stage	15 overs	3 overs	11-a-side
Division 1	20 overs	4 overs	11-a-side
Division 2	15 overs	3 overs	11-a-side

General Rules

- A new ball shall be used at the start of each innings.
- Each team must bring at least **1 new ball** to their game.
- **LBW is applicable** — standard ICC LBW rules apply.
- **Leg-bye runs are allowed** as per ICC rules.
- Batters may use batting gloves.
- **10-minute break** between innings.
- Optional **5-minute mid-innings break** if required, at the fielding side's discretion.

LBW — ICC Guidelines for Umpires

For a batsman to be given out LBW, **all** of the following conditions must be met:

1. The ball must **not pitch outside leg stump** (if it pitches outside leg, it is not out regardless).
2. The ball must **strike the batsman's pad (or body) in line with the stumps**, or — if the batsman is **not offering a shot** — the ball may strike outside the line of off stump.
3. The ball must be **going on to hit the stumps** in the umpire's judgment (height, direction, and trajectory).

Key points:

- If the batsman plays a shot and is hit outside the line of off stump → **not out**.
- If the batsman does **not** play a shot, impact outside off stump can still be given out if the ball would have hit the stumps.
- The ball must not be bouncing **too high** to hit the stumps — the umpire can review the recording if required to assess the height.

Wide Ball

- **Offside:** If any part of the ball is inside the wide line, it is **not a wide**. The ball must be entirely outside the wide guideline to be called wide.
- **Leg-side:** Any ball passing outside the leg stumps is a wide.
- If a batsman moves across the stumps before the ball is delivered, the wide line moves with the batsman — as per **ICC rules**.
- Not a wide if the striker moves and causes the ball to pass wide, or brings the ball within reach of a normal cricket stroke.
- **Above the head:** A ball that bounces and goes above head height is called a **wide** (not a no ball).

No Ball

- Ball pitching outside the turf **before the batting-end wickets (striker's end)** = **no ball**. If the ball pitches outside the turf **after passing the batting-end wickets**, it may be called a wide following wide guidelines.
- Full toss above waist height = **no ball**.
- **Bouncers:** Only **1 bouncer per over** is allowed. A bouncer is any delivery that rises **above shoulder height** of the batsman. The first bouncer above shoulder height in an over is a **warning**. The second bouncer above shoulder height in the same over is a **no ball**.
- All foot-fault no balls. Field cannot be changed if bowling to the same batsman.
- If the bowler hits the stump during delivery = **no ball** (only if the ball is delivered).

All no balls result in a free hit for the next delivery.

Other Rules

- **Run Out / Stumping — No Bails:** Since this format uses stumps without bails, the fielder must **hit the stumps with the ball** to effect a run out or stumping. If the stumps have **already been broken** (e.g., by a previous throw or by the bowler's delivery), the fielder must **uproot a stump from the ground** while holding the ball to complete the dismissal. If all stumps have been uprooted, **one stump must be re-planted** into the ground and then uprooted again with the ball in hand to complete the dismissal.
- **Retired Hurt:** A batsman who is genuinely injured may retire hurt and can return to bat later when fit. Retired hurt must be **approved by the umpire and the opposition captain**.
- **Retired Out:** A batsman who voluntarily retires (not injured) is considered retired out and **cannot return** to bat.
- **Fielding at Boundary (Catches):** If a catch is taken close to the boundary, the fielder **must hold their position** for the umpire to inspect. If the fielder moves, the umpire will make the judgment call.
- **Fielding at Boundary (4s/6s):** For boundary calls, the fielder's call is trusted — the fielder will throw the ball back and signal accordingly. **Fielders are expected to be honest.**
- **No substitute runners** — substitute runners are not allowed under any circumstances.

5. Power Play

15-Over Games (League Stage & Division 2)

Phase	Overs	Max Fielders Outside 30-Yard Circle
Powerplay	1 – 5	2
Remaining Overs	6 – 15	5

20-Over Games (Division 1)

Phase	Overs	Max Fielders Outside 30-Yard Circle
Powerplay	1 – 6	2
Remaining Overs	7 – 20	5

If overs are reduced, follow the percentage breakdown and round to the nearest whole number.

6. Umpires & Umpiring Duties

6.1 — Who Umpires?

Role	Who	Responsibility
Main Umpire (bowler's end)	Player from the assigned team (per schedule)	Makes all on-field decisions. Decision is final.
Leg Umpire (leg side)	Player from the batting team	Records the match on phone at all times. Hands footage to main umpire when requested.

- The leg umpire's **only role is to record and hand over footage**. No player or leg umpire shall discuss, argue, or influence the main umpire's decision.
- If the batting team's leg umpire **fails to record**, any disputed decision will **favor the bowling team**.

6.2 — Umpire Arrival

- Arrive approximately **10 minutes before** the scheduled start for field checks and toss.

6.3 — Main Umpire Duties (Before the Game)

- Check pitch, ground, and ball conditions.
- Ensure **Playing XI** is published before the toss.
- Authorized to check player identity via **photo ID**, especially during playoffs.

6.4 — Main Umpire Duties (During the Game)

- Ensure games start and finish as per the schedule.
- Remain **impartial** at all times — all decisions are final.
- **Enforce late arrival penalties strictly** — one delayed game must not cascade.
- Track overs when a fielder leaves the field (fielder cannot bat or bowl for that many overs).
- Keep time of all breaks and notify captains when to resume.

6.5 — Main Umpire Duties (After the Game)

- Select **Man of the Match**.

6.6 — What Can Be Checked via Recording

The leg umpire's recording may **only** be reviewed for:

✓ Allowed Checks	✗ NOT Allowed
Run outs	Sound / audio (edges, nicks, etc.) — no decisions based on sound
No balls (above waist height)	
Ball pitching — whether it pitched before or after the batsman	
Bouncer height	
Height for LBW decisions	
Whether a catch was taken cleanly	

⚠ Sound is NOT allowed to be checked. No decisions can be made based on audio/sound from the recording (e.g., edges, nicks).

6.7 — Captain Responsibility: Umpire Notification

📋 Captains must notify CAP of their umpire details:

- **Weekend games:** Provide umpire **name and phone number** in the group by **Thursday EOD**.
- **Weekday games:** Provide umpire details **2 hours before the match**.

⚠ Do NOT simply "like" or "thumbs up" the post. You **MUST** type out the umpire's **name and phone number** as a reply. CAP cannot see thumbs-up reactions as acknowledgment.

📧 You will also receive automatic email notifications from CricClubs for umpiring assignments. Ensure your email notifications are turned on.

6.8 — No-Show Umpire Fines

Offense	Penalty
First no-show	\$100 fine
Second no-show onwards	\$100 fine + 2 points deducted

The penalized team cannot play their next scheduled game until the fine has been paid.
Unpaid fines result in game forfeiture.

7. Delays & Rain Management

Non-Weather Delays

- **10 minutes after scheduled start:** 1 over deducted from the late team.
- **Every 5 minutes after that:** 1 additional over deducted.
- If one team is intentionally delaying, they may be docked 1 point.
- If a game exceeds the 3-hour window, the teams can **come back and finish** on a rescheduled day.
- If your team is unable to start on time due to the previous game overrunning, it is the **captain's responsibility** to approach the umpire and ensure the ongoing game wraps up. Otherwise your match will have **reduced overs**.
- If delays are cascading, **umpires and captains must be firm** in enforcing the time limit to protect subsequent games.

Game Rescheduling

- Teams **cannot** reschedule a game to a later date.
- A game may only be rescheduled if **both teams mutually agree** to play on a **prior (earlier) date**.

Weather / Rain Delays

- Captains and umpires will decide on playing conditions during rain.
- If it's already raining, wait for rain to stop, then assess playability.
- If rain starts after the game begins, evaluate remaining time for a reduced-overs game after rain stops.
- If both teams **cannot play at least 8 overs each**, the game is a **washout** and will be **replayed entirely** on the rescheduled day.
- If rain interrupts after **at least half of the second innings** has been completed, the game will **continue from where it was left off** on the rescheduled day.
- Washout rescheduling rules below determine when and where the game is replayed/continued.
- If a rescheduled game is **also washed out**, it becomes **split points (1 point each)**.

Washout Rescheduling

Washed-out games are rescheduled to the following week based on which ground they were originally scheduled at:

CAP Ground washouts:

- 1st washout → **Monday** (following week) at **CAP Ground**
- 2nd washout → **Tuesday** at **CAP Ground**
- Additional washouts continue to next available weekday at CAP Ground

Mossville washouts:

- 1st washout → **Monday** (following week) at **Mossville**
- 2nd washout → **Tuesday** at **Mossville**
- Additional washouts continue to next available weekday at Mossville

 If a rescheduled game is **also washed out**, it becomes **split points (1 point each)**.

Playoffs — Rain Rules

- Division 1 and Division 2 (Super Group) games follow the same washout and rescheduling rules as league games — they **can** be washed out and result in split points.
- All **semi-final and final** games **must have a result**.
- If a semi-final or final is not possible within the scheduled window, CAP reserves the right to reschedule the match.

8. Play-off & Knockout Rules

Qualification

Stage	Requirement
Knockout eligibility	Minimum 5 games played during league + division stages
Super Group 1 (Div 1)	Combined points table across both groups for Division 1 games only (points, then NRR). Top 4 qualify.
Super Group 2 (Div 2)	Combined points table across both groups for Division 2 games only (points, then NRR). Top 4 qualify.

Semi-Final Format

Each Super Group follows the same knockout format:

- Semi-Final 1: 1st vs 4th
- Semi-Final 2: 2nd vs 3rd
- Final: Winners of Semi-Final 1 and Semi-Final 2

Tied Knockout Games — Super Over (ICC Rules)

1. The team batting second in the main match bats **first** in the Super Over.
2. Each side nominates 3 batsmen. Loss of 2 wickets ends the Super Over.
3. A player **can bat and bowl** in the Super Over — as per ICC rules.
4. If the Super Over is tied, **another Super Over is played**. This continues until a result is achieved — as per ICC rules.

9. Cricket Bat Specifications

 **Captains must carry the bat gauge provided by CAP.** Any bat that does not pass through the gauge is **not allowed** in match play.

- Every bat used in a match **must pass through the CAP-provided bat gauge**. If it does not fit, the bat is not permitted.
- Overall length: max **38 inches** (including handle).
- Blade width: max **4.25 inches**.
- Blade depth: max **2.64 inches**.
- Blade edges: max **1.56 inches**.
- If a player uses a non-compliant bat and it is noticed mid-game, the bat must be replaced immediately. The umpire or any player should report it to CAP.

10. Bowling & Fielding Rules

Over Rate

- Captains are responsible for maintaining a healthy over rate to ensure game completion within the scheduled time window.

Chucking (Illegal Bowling Action)

- Defined by ICC: elbow extension exceeding **15 degrees**.
- Batsman may raise concerns with the main umpire.
- Umpire will observe the bowler's action and may call a **no ball** if convinced.
- If a bowler repeatedly chucks, the opposing team should **record video evidence** and submit it to CAP. CAP will review the footage and decide on appropriate action.

Fielding

- Any conspicuous movement or shouting by a fielder during the bowler's delivery stride is prohibited. Umpire may declare the delivery a no ball.
- **Absence Penalty:** If a fielder leaves the field of play for any reason during the innings, they are penalized for the same number of overs they were absent:
 - **Bowling:** Upon returning to the field, the player must complete the same number of overs fielding before they are permitted to bowl.
 - **Batting:** If the penalty overs have not been fully served during the fielding innings (e.g., the player returned late and the innings ended before the penalty was complete), the remaining overs carry over — the player cannot come in to bat until that many overs have been completed in the batting innings.

The umpires will track the overs of absence. This rule does not apply if the absence is due to an injury sustained during play and approved by the umpire.

11. Code of Conduct & Discipline

CAP expects all participants to demonstrate sportsmanship and respect. This is a competitive yet friendly league.

Level	Classification	Description	Penalty
0	Warning	Minor infractions, first-time violations, mild dissent	Verbal warning + documentation
1	Minor Misconduct	Repeated minor infractions, persistent arguing with umpires	1-game suspension for the player
2	Serious Misconduct	Verbal abuse, intentional unsportsmanlike conduct, threatening behavior	1-game suspension + 2 point deduction
3	Physical Altercation	Physical fights, aggression towards players/officials/spectators	12–36 month suspension + 4 point deduction + possible expulsion
4	Gross Misconduct	Significant disrepute, property damage, criminal activity	Permanent expulsion + season disqualification

Key Conduct Rules

- No physical or verbal attacks against umpires, players, equipment, spectators, or organizers.
- Umpires can eject players from the game. If the player refuses to leave, the team forfeits the match.
- Captains are responsible for their team's behavior.

12. Ground Logistics

CAP grounds have permanent pitches and boundary markings. There is no home or away team policy — all teams share equal responsibility for the facilities.

Ground Care

- Set up wickets before the game. Remove them after the last game of the day.
- Walk around the ground and surrounding areas after the game to ensure no trash is left behind.
- Report any damage to the ground or facilities to CAP immediately.
- All teams must abide by the rules and regulations of the park/township.

Equipment

Each team must carry in their kit bag:

- **Wickets** — one set per team (bails are not required)
- **Bat gauge** (provided by CAP)
- **New ball** (minimum 1 new ball per game)

Scoring

- All scorecard changes must be made on the **same day** as the game. After that, the scorecard is locked.
- Any scorecard changes needed after game day must be **notified to CAP** at cappeoria1@gmail.com.

Vehicle Safety on CAP Ground

 **All drivers entering CAP Ground must follow these rules:**

- **STOP your vehicle** when a ball is being delivered or play is in progress. Do not drive through the ground area during active play.
- Drive **slowly** at all times within the ground premises.
- Maintain the **speed limit** on W Dickison Cemetery Rd — go slow, especially when players and spectators are present.
- Park at a **safe distance** from the playing area.
- Be aware of players, children, and spectators walking around the ground.

13. Practice & Batting Cage Booking

CAP provides practice grounds and batting cages for teams to prepare for matches. All bookings are done through the **CAP Ground Booking System** at <https://cap-practice-booking.web.app>.

Only users with the **Captain** role can book slots. All other users can view availability but cannot make bookings.

How to Book

1. Log in with your Google account at cap-practice-booking.web.app.
2. Select the **Ground Booking** or **Batting Cages** tab.
3. Browse available slots and click **Book** on your preferred slot.
4. Select your team from the dropdown and confirm.

Ground Practice Slots

Rule	Details
Max teams per slot	2 teams can share a practice slot
Booking limit	1 slot per team at a time — no team can book two slots
Available grounds	CAP Ground, Mossville
Practice days	Monday – Friday (weekday evenings)

Batting Cage Slots

Rule	Details
Max bookings per slot	1 team per cage per time slot
Booking limit (weekday)	1 cage slot per user and 1 per team for weekday slots
Booking limit (weekend)	1 cage slot per user and 1 per team for weekend slots
Available cages	Cage 1, Cage 2

Cancellation

- You can cancel your booking at any time from the booking system.
- Please cancel as early as possible so other teams can use the slot.
- Only the person who booked (or a master/admin) can cancel a booking.

Reserved Slots

- CAP administrators may **reserve slots** for game days or special events.
- Reserved slots are blocked from regular booking and marked accordingly.

 **Tip:** Book your practice slots early in the week — popular time slots fill up fast!

14. Prizes & Awards

Prize details will be announced by CAP before the knockout stage.

Award	Prize
Division 1 Winner	Cash prize (amount TBD) + Cup / Trophy
Division 1 Runner-up	Cup / Trophy (cash TBD)
Division 2 Winner	Cup / Trophy
Division 2 Runner-up	Cup / Trophy
Best Batsman — Division 1	Cup / Trophy
Best Batsman — Division 2	Cup / Trophy
Best Bowler — Division 1	Cup / Trophy
Best Bowler — Division 2	Cup / Trophy
MVP — Division 1	Cup / Trophy
MVP — Division 2	Cup / Trophy
Player of the Match — Division 1 Final	Cup / Trophy
Player of the Match — Division 2 Final	Cup / Trophy

Important & Final Note

All teams must abide by the rules and regulations of the park they are playing in.
Drinking or urinating publicly is strictly prohibited.

CAP reserves the right to amend these rules at any time in the best interests of the league.

CAP is not responsible for injuries to players.

PLAY HARD. PLAY FAIR. RESPECT THE GAME. 🏏